

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN- SILCHAR REGION
PRE- BOARD EXAMINATION -1- 2024-25
SUBJECT: ENGLISH- LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (CODE NO- 184)
CLASS-X (SET-2)
SUBJECT -ENGLISH

M.M:80

TIME: 3Hrs

General Instructions:

1. This question paper contains three sections- Reading, Grammar & Writing and Literature.

❖ Section A - Reading 20 Marks

❖ Section B - Grammar and Writing Skill 20 Marks

❖ Section C - Literature 40 Marks

2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part and question.

SECTION-A
READING SKILLS (20 MARKS)

1. Read the passage carefully.

10

1. During our growing up years we as children were taught-both at home and school-to worship the photos and idols of the gods of our respective religions. When we grow a little older, we were to read holy books like The Bhagwad Gita, Bible and Quran; we were told that there are a lot of life lessons to be learnt from these holy books. We were then introduced to stories from our mythologies which taught us about ethics and morality-what is good and what is bad. I also learnt to be respectful towards my parents who made my life comfortable with their hard work and love and care, and my teachers who guided me to become a good student and a responsible citizen.

2. Much later in life, I realised that though we learn much from our respective holy books, there is a lot to learn from our surroundings. This realisation dawned upon me when I learnt to enquire and explore. Everything around us-the sun, the moon, the stars, rain, rivers, stones, rocks, birds, plants and animals-teach us many valuable life lessons.

3. No wonder that besides the scriptures in many cultures nature is also worshipped. The message that we get is to save our environment and maintain ecological balance. People are taught to live in harmony with nature and recognise that there is God in all aspects of nature.

4. Nature is a great teacher. A river never stops flowing. If it finds an obstacle in its way in the form of a heavy rock, the river water fights to remove it from its path or finds an alternative path to move ahead. This teaches us to be progressive in life, and keep the fighting spirit alive.

5. Snakes are worshipped as they eat insects in the field that can hurt our crops, thus protecting the grains for us. In fact, whatever we worship is our helper and makes our lives easy for us. There are many such examples in nature, but we are not ready to learn a lesson. Overcome with greed, we are destroying nature. As a result we face natural disasters like drought, flood and landslides. We don't know that nature is angry with us.

6. However, it is never too late to learn. If we learn to respect nature, the quality of our life will improve.

On the basis of your reading of the above extract, answer the following questions .

(i) The author suggests that our failure to learn from nature, driven by _____, leads to environmental destruction and natural disasters.

(1)

- a. Ignorance
- b. Curiosity

- c. Greed
- d. Respect

(ii) What are we taught in our childhood and growing up years? (1)

(iii) Which of the following best describes the author's view on the relationship between humans and nature? (1)

- a. Nature is a resource to be exploited for human benefit.
- b. Humans should worship nature exclusively rather than engage with it.
- c. Respecting and learning from nature can improve the quality of human life.
- d. Nature should be kept separate from human activities to prevent disasters.

(iv) How does a river face an obstacle that comes in its way? (2)

(v) The passage asserts that all aspects of nature should be regarded as divine and respected to maintain ecological balance. (1)

- a. True
- b. False

(vi) What does the author imply about the role of mythological stories in childhood education? (1)

(vii) Which of the following words is a synonym for 'resilient' as used in the context of the passage regarding the river?

(1)

- a. Fragile
- b. Adaptable
- c. Static
- d. Weak

(viii) Examine the implications of the author's statement that "it is never too late to learn" in the context of environmental respect and personal growth in about 40 words. (2)

2. Read the passage carefully.

1. The next few decades will see great changes in the way energy is supplied and used. In some major oil producing nations, 'peak oil' has already been reached, and there are increasing fears of global warming. Consequently, many countries are focusing on the switch to a low carbon economy. This transition will lead to major changes in the supply and use of electricity. Firstly, there will be an increase in overall demand, as consumers switch from oil and gas to electricity to power their homes and vehicles. Secondly, there will be an increase in power generation, not only in terms of how much is generated, but also how it is generated, as there is growing electricity generation from renewable sources. To meet these challenges, countries are investing in Smart Grid technology. This system aims to provide the electricity industry with a better understanding of power generation and demand, and to use this information to create a more efficient power network.

2. Smart Grid technology basically involves the application of a computer system to the electricity network. The computer system can be used to collect information about supply and demand and improve engineer's ability to manage the system. With better information about electricity demand, the network will be able to increase the amount of electricity delivered per unit generated, leading to potential reductions in fuel needs and carbon emissions. Moreover, the computer system will assist in reducing operational and maintenance costs.

3. Smart Grid technology offers benefits to the consumer too. They will be able to collect real-time information on their energy use for each appliance. Varying tariffs throughout the day will give customers the incentive to use appliances at times when supply greatly exceeds demand, leading to great reductions in bills. For example, they may use their washing machines at night. Smart meters can also be connected to the internet or telephone system, allowing customers to switch appliances on or off remotely. Furthermore, if houses are fitted with the on-site power source, and any excess can be sold to the grid.

4. With these changes comes a range of challenges. The first involves managing the supply and demand.

Sources of renewable energy, such as wind, wave and solar, are notoriously unpredictable, and nuclear power, which is also set to increase as nations switch to alternative energy sources, is inflexible. With oil and gas, it is relatively simple to increase the supply of energy to match the increasing demand during peak times of the day or year. With alternative sources, this is far more difficult, and may lead to blackouts or system collapse. Potential solutions include investigating new and efficient ways to store energy and encouraging consumers to use electricity at off-peak times.

5. A second problem is the fact that many renewable power generation sources are located in remote areas, such as windy uplands and coastal regions, where there is currently a lack of electrical infrastructure. New infrastructures therefore must be built. Thankfully, with improved smart technology, this can be done more efficiently by reducing the reinforcement or construction costs.

6. Although Smart Technology is still in its infancy, pilot schemes to promote and test it are already underway. Consumers are currently testing the new smart meters which can be used in their homes to manage electricity use. There are also a number of demonstrations being planned to show how the smart technology could practically work, and trials are in place to test the new electrical infrastructure. It is likely that technology will be added in "layers", starting with 'quick win' methods which will provide initial carbon savings, to be followed by more advanced systems at a later date. Cities are prime candidates for investment into smart energy, due to the high population density and high energy use. It is here where Smart Technology is likely to be promoted first, utilizing a range of sustainable power sources, transport solutions and an infrastructure for charging electrically powered vehicles. The infrastructure is already changing fast. By the year 2050, changes in the energy supply will have transformed our homes, our roads and our behavior.

On the basis of your reading of the passage given above, answer the following questions: (10)

- (i) According to paragraph 1, what has happened in some oil producing nations (1)
(a) They are unwilling to sell their oil any more.
(b) They are not producing as much oil as they used to.
(c) The supply of oil is unpredictable.
(d) Global warming is more severe here than in other countries.
- (ii) What primary benefit does Smart Grid technology provide to energy consumers according to the passage? (1)
- (iii) According to passage, what is the problem with using renewable sources of power? (1)
(a) They do not provide much energy.
(b) They often cause system failure and blackouts.
(c) They do not supply a continuous flow of energy.
(d) They can't be used at off-peak times.
- (iv) How does Smart Grid technology enhance consumer engagement with energy usage, according to the passage? (2)
- (v) The transition to a low carbon economy will lead to an increase in overall demand as consumers switch from oil and gas to _____ to power their homes and vehicles. (1)
a. Coal
b. Electricity
c. renewable resources
d. nuclear energy
- (vi) What challenges does the passage identify regarding the construction of new electrical infrastructure for renewable energy sources? (2)
- (vii) How does the passage describe the future changes in energy supply by the year 2050? (1)
- (viii) The word 'remote' in paragraph 5 could be best replaced by: (1)
a. isolated

- b. crowded
c. attractive
d. alone

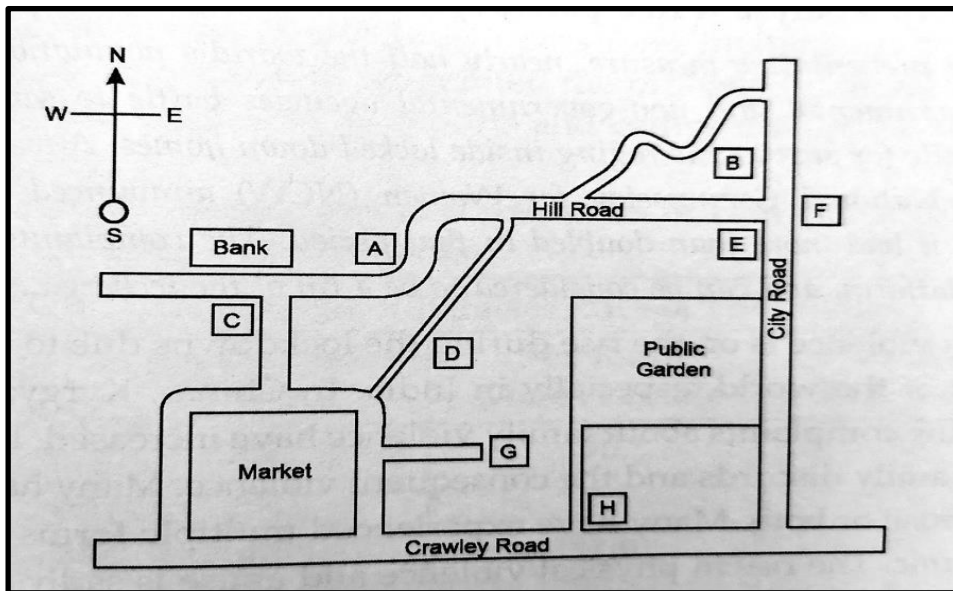
	SECTION B : GRAMMAR & WRITING SECTION	20						
3.	GRAMMAR: Attempt <u>ANY TEN</u> questions:	10						
i	It has been decided that the function _____from tomorrow. a) Has started b) Will be start c) Will start d) started	1						
ii	Meena: Can you sing a song for me Ayesha? Ayesha: Yes, I will sing for you now. Meeana asked Ayesha if she could sing a song for her. Ayesha agreed and said that_____.	1						
iii	Neha _____climb trees when she was 8 years old. a) Can b) Could c) Should d) may	1						
iv	Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line: Shreyas says that he would make new rules for the class if he was the class teacher. <table border="1" style="width: 100%;"> <tr> <td style="width: 33%;">Option no.</td> <td style="width: 33%;">Error</td> <td style="width: 33%;">Correction</td> </tr> <tr> <td style="height: 150px;"></td> <td></td> <td></td> </tr> </table>	Option no.	Error	Correction				1
Option no.	Error	Correction						

	<table> <tr> <td>A.</td><td>that</td><td>if</td></tr> <tr> <td>B.</td><td>would</td><td>will</td></tr> <tr> <td>C.</td><td>the</td><td>a</td></tr> <tr> <td>D.</td><td>was</td><td>were</td></tr> </table>	A.	that	if	B.	would	will	C.	the	a	D.	was	were	
A.	that	if												
B.	would	will												
C.	the	a												
D.	was	were												
v	I felt sorry to say that the guests _____ before my parents came. a) departed b) had departed c) were departing d) depart	1												
vi	Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter. Subject: Application for Sickness Respected Sir, I _____(suffer)from high fever since last night so am unable to attend the school for at least three days.	1												
vii	Report the dialogue between a mother and her son, by completing the sentence: Rohan: Mom, are you busy today? Mother: Yes, I can not go with you to the party. In response to the question about a busy day, mother says that she is busy and _____.	1												
viii	Identify the error in the given sentence and supply its correction: The company has propose to open a new branch in the nearest city this year for more profit. Error _____ Correction _____	1												
ix	Select the correct option to complete the narration of the dialogue: Manager: Why don't you take a day off? Mr. Sandeep: Because I want to give my best in this project. The manager asked Mr. Sandeep why he did not take a day off. Mr. Sandeep	1												

	answered that _____. a) he wants to give his best in that project. b) he wanted to give his best in this project. c) he wanted to give his best in that project. d) he wanted to give his best.					
x	Identify the error and supply its correction: A pair of scissors that were lying on the table, has been lost.	1				
	<table><tr><td>Error</td><td>Correction</td></tr><tr><td></td><td></td></tr></table>		Error	Correction		
	Error		Correction			
xi	Himesh asked a question from Divya about her preparation for the examination. Report his question: Have you learnt all the chapters? Himesh asked Divya if _____.	1				
xii	We _____ help the needy people. a) may b) might c) could d) must	1				
4.	CREATIVE WRITING	10				
	ATTEMPT ANY ONE FROM A AND B GIVEN BELOW: <i>(All the names and addresses used in questions 1A & 1B are fictitious. Resemblance, if any, is purely coincidental.)</i>	5				
A	You are Naina from 65, PH Road, Mangalore. You bought a fully automatic machine from Modern Gadgets, Mangalore, last month. The machine is not functioning properly and making unbearable noise when switched on. Write a letter to the dealer complaining about the product by adding necessary details.					
	OR					
B	You are Mr. Manish, the Tour In charge of Grand Public School, Rajasthan. Your school is planning to organize an educational tour to Shimla during summer vacation. Write a letter to The National Travel Agency, Shimla inquiring about the charges, facilities and other details.					
5.	ATTEMPT ANY ONE FROM A AND B GIVEN BELOW:	5				

A

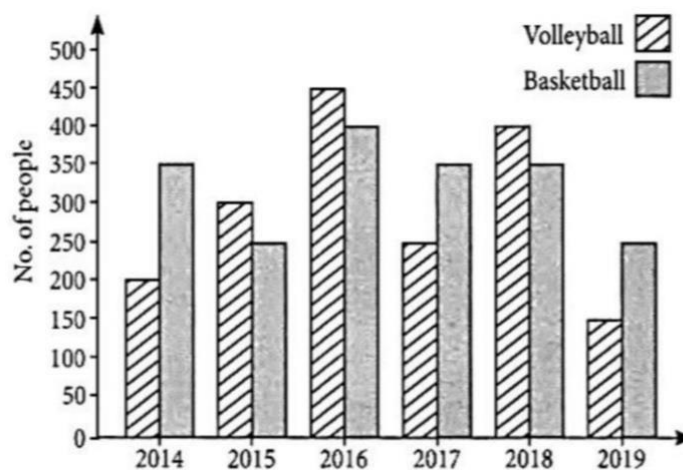
The following is the map of an important area of a city. Write an Analytical Paragraph in 100-120 words on it.



OR

B

The given double bar graph shows the preferences of children in a school in playing different games over the span of six years. Write an analytical paragraph about the given information.



SECTION C: LITERATURE

40

6	Read the extracts given below and attempt ANY ONE, by answering the questions that follow.	5
A	The fiercely independent people of Coorg are possibly of Greek or Arabic descent. As one story goes, a part of Alexander's army moved south along the coast and settled here when return became impractical. These people married amongst the locals and their culture is apparent in the martial traditions, marriage and religious rites, which are distinct from the Hindu mainstream.	
i	Which one is not true: a) Coorgis are dependent. b) They are possibly Greek or Arabic. c) They are brave. d) The Coorgi tradition is different from Hindu mainstream.	1.
ii	Why did the army settle in Coorg?	2
iii	How can one say that Coorgis are descendants of Greek or Arab? a) It is a fact. b) Because of old stories. c) Because of their distinct tradition, culture and religious rites. d) Because they are brave.	1
iv.	Find the word that is similar in meaning to "Clear" from the lines.	1
	OR	
B	THINK-TANK : (smacking mirror) Quicker. Answer quicker next time. I hate a slow mirror. (He admires himself in the mirror.) Ah, there I am. Are we Martians not a handsome race? So much more attractive than those ugly Earthlings with their tiny heads. Noodle, you keep on exercising your mind, and someday you'll have a balloon brain just like mine. NOODLE : Oh, I hope so, Mighty Think-Tank. I hope so. THINK-TANK : Now, contact the space probe. I want to invade that primitive ball of mud called Earth before lunch. NOODLE : It shall be done, sir. (He adjusts levers on the switchboard. Electronic buzzes and beeps are heard as the curtains open.)	
i	According to the lines, what does Think Tank dislike? 1. Earthlings	1
	2. Late reply 3. His own face 4. Noodle a) Option 1 & 2 b) Option 4 c) Option 1 d) Option 1,2 & 3	

ii	Complete the analogy: Handsome: Ugly... Huge: _____	1
iii	What does Think-Tank think of Earth and its inhabitants?	2
iv.	True/False: Noodle is an apprentice, polite and intelligent Martian. _____	1
7 A	Read the extracts given below and attempt ANY ONE, by answering the questions that follow. He stalks in his vivid stripes The few steps of his cage, On pads of velvet quite, In his quiet rage. He should be lurking in shadow, Sliding through long grass Near the water hole Where plump deer pass.	
i	The rhyme scheme of the second stanza is: a) abab b) abcb c) abba d) aaab	1
ii	The stanzas bring out the contrast between a) The tiger in the zoo and the tiger as a pet animal. b) The tiger in the zoo and the tiger in its natural habitat. c) The strength of a tiger and a lion. d) The wild animals and the pet animals.	1
iii	The word 'rage' does have a meaning similar to _____	1
iv	Why does the tiger walk only a few steps?	2
7 B	OR (I am Rapunzel, I have not a care; life in a tower is tranquil and rare; I'll certainly never let down my bright hair!) Stop that sulking at once, Amanda! You're always so moody, Amanda! Anyone would think that I nagged at you, Amanda!	

i	The parenthesis () in the above stanza is here to convey: a) The speaker is lost in her own dreams. b) The speaker imagines sleeping for long hours. c) The speaker is a smart girl who wants to play the role of Rapunzel in a Play. d) The speaker wants to climb a tower.	1
ii	The poetic device used in the phrase- 'I am Rapunzel' is a) simile b) alliteration c) metaphor d) onomatopoeia	1
iii	The word 'tranquil' DOES NOT have a meaning similar to a) confused b) calm c) peaceful d) relaxing	1
iv	What does Amanda's mood suggest about her feelings in the poem?	2
8	ANSWER ANY FOUR OF THE FOLLOWING IN ABOUT 30-40 WORDS EACH:	4X3=12
i	What information did Valli collect about the bus ride? How did she do that?	
ii	How Mr. Keesing punished Anne Frank? Why was she punished?	
iii	How do you say Custard the dragon, a truly brave animal and an honest friend?	
iv	What do people think about the end of the world? Who does the poet side with and why?	
v	Write a short note on the relationship between the author and his pet Mijbil.	
9	ANSWER ANY TWO OF THE FOLLOWING IN ABOUT 30-40 WORDS EACH:	2X3=6
i	What had happened to Tricki? How did the narrator cure him?	
ii	Why did Ramlal accept Bishamber's proposal of marrying Bholi?	
iii	Write a character sketch of Griffin, the scientist.	
10	ANSWER ANY ONE OF THE FOLLOWING IN ABOUT 100-120 WORDS EACH:	1X6=6

i	'Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom' describes the value of freedom in life and how it is necessary for civilization to grow. What value do you derive out of it to make life an enjoyable experience?	
	OR	
ii	"Rich people and youngsters are generally self centered and always ready to take chances by forgetting and accepting anything if it comes for their own benefits". Explain the statement in context with the play 'The Proposal'.	
11	ANSWER ANY ONE OF THE FOLLOWING IN ABOUT 100-120 WORDS EACH:	1X6=6
i	In 'The Thief's Story' the thief gives up stealing and decides to become great through education. Giving various values that the story parts, write how this value together with hard work is important in life.	
	OR	
ii	"Show off and a fake life may give temporary happiness but bring misfortune and problems in future." Explain the statement by linking it to the desires and behavior of Matilda Loisel.	